

get AdaptiveSync included in the latest iteration of their popular standard, which allowed compatible GPUs and monitors to negotiate the monitor refresh rate between them. Obviously, it requires no proprietary elements as compared to NVIDIA's approach.

But since this is not really a NVIDIA hate campaign, we came across some drawbacks from AMD's solution as well. Although it works fine within the monitor's refresh rate, when it comes to exceeding or underperforming it, the lack of NVIDIA's tricks are apparent on AMD's solution as it switches to standard VSync, which means - back to tearing and stuttering.

Competitive Technology or Brand War?

It is good to have big brands competing to solve a general technology problem. In fact, the biggest example of this is the smartphone wars and how the consumer has benefited from it. But that is when the options are plenty. Here, in case of display technology, the options are anything but plenty when it comes to variable refresh rate technology. And this one's a costly brand war.

Display technology does not come cheap, both in terms of monitors and graphics cards. And an incompatibility challenge between two of the leading GPU manufacturers can pull the entire scenario into chaos. Already there is quite a significant disapproval in the market regarding NVIDIA's proprietary approach. The fact is, gamers like to have the power to change and alter their PC to incorporate latest upgrades every now and then, and no gamer wants their options forcibly limited because they chose to go for a monitor that only supports certain GPU units.

And all this bloodshed for what? Both comprehensive reviews by expert test labs as well as common user feedback has returned no noticeable difference between the two implementations, and wherever there has been a drop in performance, it has been there for both.

Our only hope lies in the fact that any open platform eventually receives wider acceptance in the market. No one wants another wide gaping divide in an already highly segregated world of technology. After all, whenever it comes to brand wars in a new market, it is consumers who are the unavoidable collateral damage. 